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ICER Recruiting Team
Institute for Cyber-Enabled Research
Michigan State University

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Dear ICER Team,

Helping researchers spend less time wrestling with job schedulers and more time doing science is a problem I find genuinely interesting. I am a junior Computer Science student at Michigan State University applying for the **LLM Research and Development Technician** position at ICER. Building an **AI agent** that understands a user's code and translates it into a correct HPCC submission is exactly the kind of practical, measurable AI work I want to be doing.

My background maps directly to what this role requires. I am fluent in **Python** and comfortable on the command line, having administered Linux servers and Docker infrastructure for years on my personal home lab. Through MSU's AI Club, I lead workshops for 500+ students and built a production application integrating a **Python** backend with the OpenAI API, giving me hands-on experience with **agentic AI** pipelines. At MHacks 2025, I built SoundSense, a real-time audio classification system with a **machine learning** backend, winning 2nd place, which required designing validation tests to confirm model accuracy under production conditions. I also built Nexus, a server management platform in Python, where I developed testing and monitoring pipelines to evaluate system reliability across concurrent operations. Designing evaluation schemas to measure how well an agent interprets and transforms user code is a natural extension of that work.

ICER's position is unique because it combines agent development with real research outcomes: the results I gather will be presented to MSU leadership and at research forums. That accountability to a concrete research question, not just shipping a feature, is the kind of environment where I do my best work. I would welcome the chance to contribute to this project.

Best regards,

Laith Assaf